

Hoisting rope pulls the elevator up and pulls the springs taut at the same time. If the rope breaks, the safety mechanism kicks in.



Two sturdy springs on top of the lifting platform are kept taut by the rope, but get stuck in the metal teeth if the rope snaps.

How it changed

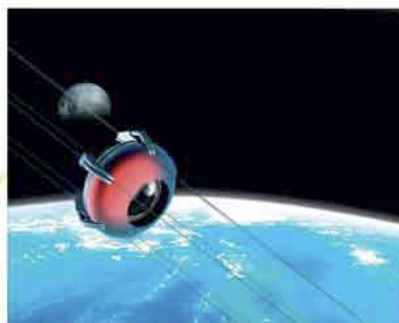
Elevators allowed cities to grow upward instead of sideways. This saved precious space where land was already in short supply.

High-rise living may get higher still as new carbon-fiber cables enable elevators to travel farther.

the world

People and objects riding on the platform were safe at last.

Into the future...



Electrified elevators

Steam elevators puffed away until the 1880s when the first electric elevator was installed. **Electric-powered pulleys** at the top of the shaft meant that elevators could climb **HIGHER AND FASTER** than they had in the past. Elevators were developed to become **automatic**, with passengers able to call an elevator and specify a floor at the push of a button.



Skyscrapers

Now that people could scale tall buildings quickly and safely, **skyscrapers** began to reach higher and higher, transforming cities. Chicago's **CONWAY BUILDING**, now known as the Burnham Center, is one example. When completed in 1913, it stood **300 ft (91 m)** tall.

A **SPACE ELEVATOR** could one day be available to carry people into space without a rocket. The elevator would use a superstrong, superlight **CARBON-FIBER CABLE**.